

Mobile Application Development with Flutter

Lecture 45. Dropdown in Flutter

What is Dropdown?

- Dropdown is a widget that displays a list of options in a popup, allowing the user to select one value



Real-World Use Cases

- Country selection
- Gender selection
- Payment method
- Language selection
- Category selection

Options for Dropdown

- DropdownButton (Old)
 - Part of older Material design (Material 2)
 - Widely used in tutorials
 - Still works, but not recommended for new apps
- DropdownMenu (New)
 - Introduced in **Material 3**
 - Modern UI
 - More flexible and powerful
 - Recommended by Flutter now

DropDownMenu in Flutter

- In Flutter, the DropDownMenu is a **Material 3** widget that combines a text input field with a dropdown list.
- It offers built-in search and filtering capabilities
- Key Features:
 - Integrated TextField
 - Material 3 Ready
 - Search and Traversal
 - State Management

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Differences from DropdownButton

Feature	DropdownButton	DropdoenMenu
Design	Material 2 (older)	Material 3 (Modern)
Search	Requires manual logic	Built-in via TextField
Items	DropdownMenuItem	DropdownMenuEntry
Callback	onChanged	onSelected

Important Note

👉 To use DropdownMenu properly, enable Material 3

```
MaterialApp(  
  theme: ThemeData(  
    useMaterial3: true,  
  ),  
)
```